

FORGE Phase 2 · Week 17 · Session 51 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 51: Simulation 2 — Gossip and Reputation Damage" in the Phase 2 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 51 as written runs about 98 minutes. This insert adds an opening video, a **scenario video** of Simulation 2 that you play in two parts, and one talk, which fills the session to two hours.

What's in this insert

- **Video 51A, "Simulation 2: Gossip and Reputation Damage"** (1 min 38 s). Yesterday's property dispute and today's scenario side by side; the guide's "On the outside, gossip is annoying. In here, gossip can be dangerous."; what a mentor can't control and can't ignore; and what this simulation tests (gossip or a credible threat, OARS when a man wants action, boundaries, knowing when it needs staff). It ends on the check-in question, *What did you take from yesterday's simulation that's still on your mind?*, and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **Video 51B, "Simulation 2: Thomas"** (2 min 39 s). The guide's scene acted out at a dayroom table: Thomas tells the mentor someone is saying he cooperated with staff, and asks him to talk to Jackson. The video **stops for 20 seconds** on the guide's question (*What's your assessment of the danger level?*), then shows one way a mentor could handle it, in the guide's words: validation first, an open question, and the answer to "Don't tell staff" ("That's not about snitching. That's about keeping you alive."). It shows what a mentor can and can't do, and ends on the second run's extra layer: Jackson stops the mentor in the common area.
- **A talk on thinking clearly under stress:** Daniel Levitin, *How to stay calm when you know you'll be stressed* (TEDGlobal London, 12 minutes 10 seconds). A neuroscientist on why stress clouds your thinking, and why the time to think a hard situation through is before it arrives.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Video 51A	2	Play it first. It ends on the check-in question; go straight into the round.
0:02	Opening Circle	10	As written (the question is already on screen).
0:12	Pre-Simulation Discussion: Gossip, Labels, and Safety	10	The video gave a short version of the guide's opening. Ask the men why gossip in here is different, and let them build the rest.
0:22	Video 51B, first part, then Simulation 2 Setup	3	The video acts out the scene you would read aloud. Stop it on the pause card (about 50 seconds in) and do not play the rest yet: the first attempt is meant to show the mentor's own instincts. Assign roles as written.
0:25	Simulation 2: First Run	27	As written, with the complications during the replay.

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:52	Video 51B, the rest	2	After the debrief, play from the pause to the end. It covers the guide's key debrief points: validation first, the open question, the hardest moment ("Don't tell staff"), and what a mentor can and can't do. It ends on the Jackson layer for the second run; leave that card up while the men write.
0:54	Document Lessons Learned	5	Same three questions as Session 50.
0:59	Second Run: Different Mentor	30	As written, with the Jackson encounter the video set up.
1:29	Document Lessons Learned — Second Run	3	As written.
1:32	Talk: Daniel Levitin, <i>How to stay calm when you know you'll be stressed</i>	12	Introduce it in one sentence: "Thomas wasn't thinking straight, and under pressure neither are we. Here's a neuroscientist on why, and what to do about it ahead of time."
1:44	Talk discussion	4	One or two questions from below.
1:48	Closing Circle	10	As written, with the weekend homework. The talk leads into the guide's closing line: composure is the foundation.
1:58	Buffer	2	

Questions for *How to stay calm when you know you'll be stressed*

1. Levitin says stress floods your brain with cortisol and clouds rational, logical thinking. Where did you see that in Thomas today? Where did you see it in the mentor?
2. His answer is a "pre-mortem": think ahead to what could go wrong and put something in place before it happens. What would a mentor want to have thought through before a man comes to him with a rumor like this one?
3. He hangs his keys on a hook by the door so he never has to think about it under stress. What is your "hook by the door" as a mentor: a decision you make now, so you don't have to make it in the moment? (For example: when you will involve staff.)

About the scenario video

The men in Video 51B are actors made for this video; none is a real person. Thomas's words are the guide's, and so are the mentor's key lines; a few connecting lines were added. Jackson is heard, not seen. The video shows *one* way to handle it. If a mentor in the room assessed the danger differently and could explain why, that is the conversation the guide wants.

Links, and getting a copy you can play without internet

- *How to stay calm when you know you'll be stressed* (Daniel Levitin, TEDGlobal London) — **YouTube** (TED): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8jPQjjsBbIc> · also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/daniel_levitin_how_to_stay_calm_when_you_know_you_ll_be_stressed

Preview before class. The middle of the talk is about medical decisions (cholesterol drugs and prostate surgery) as an example of thinking ahead. Nothing in it is graphic.

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Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 51A and 51B and the talk loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ You know where to stop Video 51B (the pause card, about 50 seconds in) and that the rest plays after the first debrief
- ☐ Talk previewed and cleared under the facility's media rules